LORATADINE

Least sedating

Once daily

CHEMICAL NAME Ethyl 4-(8-chloro-5,6-dihydro-11H-benzo[5,6]cyclohepta[1,2-b]pyridin-11-ylidene)piperidine-1-carboxylate

CLASS Second-generation (non-sedating) H1 antihistamine

TRADE NAMES Claritin · Clarityn · Lorano · Clarinase (with pseudoephedrine)

THERAPEUTIC USES / INDICATIONS

- Allergic rhinitis and conjunctivitis.
- Chronic urticaria.
- Allergic skin reactions.

PHARMACODYNAMICS

- Selective peripheral **H1 antagonist**; minimal CNS penetration → little sedation.

ADMINISTRATION

- **PO** once daily with or without food.

DOSAGES

- **Adult & child >30 kg:** 10 mg once daily.
- **Children 2–12 yr ≤30 kg:** 5 mg once daily.
- Severe hepatic impairment: 10 mg every other day.

PHARMACOKINETICS

- **Onset:** 1–3 h. **Duration:** 24 h.
- Metabolised in liver (CYP3A4, 2D6) to desloratadine (active).
- Excreted in urine and faeces. **t½:** 8 h (desloratadine 28 h).

SIDE & ADVERSE EFFECTS

SIDE EFFECTS (COMMON)

- Headache, fatigue.
- Dry mouth.
- Nausea.

ADVERSE EFFECTS (SERIOUS)

- Tachycardia, palpitations (rare).
- Hepatic dysfunction (rare).
- Hypersensitivity.

CONTRAINDICATIONS & CAUTIONS

- Hypersensitivity.
- **Caution:** severe hepatic impairment.

KEY INTERACTIONS

- **Ketoconazole, erythromycin, cimetidine:** ↑ levels (clinically minor).
- Alcohol: no significant potentiation.

NURSING MANAGEMENT

- Assess allergy symptoms.
- Adjust dose in severe hepatic impairment.

PATIENT EDUCATION

- Take once daily.
- Unlikely to cause drowsiness but check your response.
- Stop several days before allergy skin tests.

KEY POINTS

- Non-sedating H1 antihistamine.
- Prodrug of desloratadine.
- 10 mg once daily.
- Hepatic dose adjustment.

SOURCES CHECKED **[491]** Loratadine 10 mg Tablets (UK SmPC)

Full references p. 432–457